THE MIRROR MODEL

A Peer Support Protocol for Coherent Decision-Making

NPT Review Conference Attendees · New York, 27 April – 22 May 2026

Gaynor Kim-Sing · Global Stewardship Council · May 2, 2026

> *"The machine is the mirror. The humans are the healers. Love is the medicine."*

HOW IT ALL FITS TOGETHER

FOUNDATION		THIS DOCUMENT		THE OUTCOME
Ancestral Dimension of AI Safety Reactive humans generate reactive AI. Inherited stress patterns narrow what we can perceive and decide.	→	**The Mirror Model Protocol** Structured peer listening + nervous system regulation = expanded perception before decisions.	→	**Coherent Negotiators** Calmer physiology. Wider perception. Better decisions. Human-directed AI.

The problem: Negotiators make consequential decisions under physiological stress — sleep-deprived, time-pressured, reactive. AI amplifies this reactivity.

The solution: 5 minutes of nervous system preparation + 30–45 minutes of peer listening = measurably expanded perception. No technology required.

WHAT THE SCIENCE CONFIRMS — THE HUMAN FACTOR

Five findings that matter in this room, right now:

1. **Your nervous system is designed for connection.** Safety and belonging are biological needs. A person who feels genuinely heard moves physiologically toward calm — measurably, within minutes.
2. **Stress is a bandwidth problem, not a reality problem.** What feels like an impasse is often a perception limit. Regulate the nervous system and the range of options you can see expands. The situation has not changed — your access to it has.
3. **The heart leads the brain.** HRV research confirms the heart sends more signals to the brain than vice versa. Coherent breathing (5-5-5 rhythm) shifts cognitive function measurably in under 5 minutes.
4. **Every party at this table is their nervous system's best current strategy.** Reactivity begets reactivity. A regulated delegate perceives more options in a counterpart's position — and generates more options in response. This is not idealism. It is neurobiology.
5. **Small coherent groups influence larger systems.** A 2026 peer-reviewed study found that groups of 1,000–2,200 people in coherent states measurably affected global measurement systems ($p < 0.01$). You do not need the whole room. You need enough people regulated to shift what is possible.

WHY NOW

The conference:

- 11th NPT RevCon, New York, 27 Apr – 22 May 2026
- 2015 and 2022 conferences both failed to reach consensus
- A third failure would severely damage the NPT's credibility
- UN NPT RevCon 2026 →

The human factor:

- "One misunderstanding away from nuclear annihilation" — UN Secretary-General
- Stress narrows perception. Narrow perception = missed openings
- Coherent negotiators hear more, assume less, decide better
- AI tools only help if the human using them is regulated

THE SCIENCE — AT A GLANCE

	Principle	Plain English	Source
❤️	**HRV Coherence**	5 minutes of rhythmic breathing shifts your nervous system into measurably better function — more than 5 min of mindfulness meditation.	HeartMath / Elbers & McCraty 2025
🤝	**Polyvagal Co-Regulation**	One calm nervous system calms another. Being truly heard activates the social engagement system and measurably reduces stress hormones.	Porges, Polyvagal Theory, 2011
🧬	**Epigenetic Modifiability**	Inherited stress patterns are not fixed. Safe, coherent relationships change which genes are expressed — toward healing and flexibility.	Lipton 2005 Meaney & Szyf
👂	**Peer Support Efficacy**	Structured peer listening reduces cortisol, increases oxytocin, improves immune function. Accurate listening is a physiological intervention.	Co-Counselling International
🌐	**Group Coherence Effects**	Peer-reviewed 2026 study: 1,000–2,200 people in coherent states measurably affected global measurement systems ($p < 0.01$). Small regulated groups shift larger dynamics.	Dispenza & HeartMath,

PART 1: PRE-SESSION PREPARATION — 5 MINUTES

Before any negotiation, difficult conversation, or AI interaction. Both people. No equipment needed.

#	Step	What to do	Time
1	**Settle**	Sit. Close eyes. 3 slow breaths. Feel your body contact the chair.	1 min
2	**Notice**	Ask silently: "What am I carrying that may not be mine — a pattern, a tension, an inherited reaction?"	1 min
3	**Return**	"I bring my attention back to this moment, to this room, to this task."	1 min
4	**Heart Coherence**	Hand on heart. Breathe: in 5 counts · hold 5 · out 5. Repeat 3 times.	2 min
5	**Intention**	"What quality do I want to bring? Clarity? Precision? Genuine curiosity?"	30 sec

PART 2: THE SESSION — 30–45 MINUTES

Two people. Equal time. No hierarchy. Not therapy — structured peer support.

Person A — Speaker	Person B — Listener	AI Tool — Optional
Shares honestly. Does the prep.	Listens without fixing, advising, or interrupting. Reflects back what was heard.	Guides timing. Neutral summaries only. Flags crisis language. Never acts alone.

#	Phase	What happens	Time
1	**Opening**	Both share one-sentence intention for the session.	2 min
2	**First Sharing**	A speaks. B listens — no fixing, no advice, full presence.	10–15 min
3	**Reflection**	B: "What I heard you say is..." A confirms or corrects.	2 min
4	**Human Response**	B: "What resonated with me was..." Not analysis — resonance.	2 min
5	**Pattern ID**	Together name one recurring theme, without judgment.	3 min
6	**Switch**	Repeat steps 2–5 with roles reversed.	15–25 min

7	**Integrate**	Each shares: one insight + one small concrete action before next time.	5 min
8	**Close**	Shared silence. Gratitude.	1 min

Safety Protocol

Participant distressed:
Pause. "Take your time. I'm here." Do not advise or rescue.

Crisis concern:
Pause. Connect to pre-identified professional resources immediately.

AI fails:
Continue without it. The protocol works entirely without technology.

AI Integration

Structure:
Guides timing — humans override at any point.

Reflection:
Neutral summary only — B reads aloud, A confirms.

Safety flag:
Monitors for crisis language — humans respond, not AI.

The healing happens between the humans.

QUICK REFERENCE — TEAR-OUT CARD

Before (5 min)	During (30–45 min)	After
• 1. Settle — 3 breaths • 2. Notice — what am I carrying? • 3. Return — attention to now • 4. Coherence — hand on heart, 5-5-5 • 5. Intention — choose a quality	• A shares · B listens fully • B reflects · A confirms • Name one pattern together • Switch roles · repeat • One insight · one concrete action	**Ask yourself:** *"What did I learn?"* *"What will I carry forward?"* *"What one small thing will I do differently today?"*

You don't have to believe in anything you can't measure.

The breathing works. The listening works. The science is real. Start there.

Full reference document continues on next page.

THE MIRROR MODEL — Full Reference

For Diplomats, Negotiators & Decision-Makers · Gaynor Kim-Sing · Global Stewardship Council · May 2, 2026 · CC0

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Companion to	The Ancestral Dimension of AI Safety — Document 3 in this repository
Repository	github.com/GlobalStewardship2026/global-stewardship-charter-2026-public-review
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Workflow	AI-executed · Human-directed

WHAT IS THIS & WHY DOES IT EXIST?

The context

- Nuclear risk is at its highest since the Cold War
- NPT RevCon is underway — 2015 and 2022 both failed to reach consensus
- Negotiators are under extreme stress, sleep-deprived, time-pressured
- Stress narrows perception — negotiators miss openings they would otherwise see
- AI tools amplify whatever state the human operator brings

The decision-maker's state IS the variable.

The opportunity

- The nervous system can shift in under 5 minutes
- Being truly heard is a measurable physiological intervention
- Coherent groups make better collective decisions — this is peer-reviewed
- These effects are replicable without technology or belief systems
- No prior training, no special equipment, no hierarchy required

Regulation is a skill. This protocol makes it accessible anywhere.

THE HUMAN FACTOR — FIVE THINGS THE SCIENCE HAS CONFIRMED

These are not philosophical claims. They are peer-reviewed findings with direct implications for everyone in this negotiating hall.

What the science shows	What it means for this room
Your physiology shapes what you can perceive. Stress is a bandwidth limit.	What feels like an ideological impasse is often a nervous system state. Regulate the state and the impasse may dissolve — or at least reveal new paths.
The heart sends more signals to the brain than vice versa (HRV research).	Heart coherence — achievable in 5 minutes of rhythmic breathing — measurably improves executive function, emotional regulation, and decision quality.

Being accurately heard is a physiological intervention (Polyvagal theory).	A colleague who listens without fixing or judging creates measurable neurological safety. This is not softness — it is strategy.
Inherited stress patterns influence current perception and behaviour (Epigenetics).	Tensions in this room carry the weight of generations. Naming that — and choosing not to be run by it — is an act of statecraft.
Small coherent groups measurably influence larger system dynamics (HeartMath, 2026).	You do not need the whole room to shift. A handful of regulated, present negotiators changes what is possible for everyone.

THE EVIDENCE BASE — FULL DETAIL

Principle	What the research shows	Key sources
Heart Rate Variability (HRV) Coherence	Coherent breathing increases HRV within minutes. HRV coherence biofeedback reduces stress, anxiety, and depression. 5 min of rhythmic breathing produces greater mood improvement than 5 min of mindfulness. Heart fields synchronize between people — measurable several feet apart.	Elbers & McCraty 2025 HeartMath Research
Polyvagal Co-Regulation	A calm nervous system helps calm another. Being heard by a safe person activates the ventral vagal social engagement system — measurably reducing cortisol and restoring cognitive flexibility.	Porges, The Polyvagal Theory, 2011
Epigenetic Modifiability	Gene expression is not fixed. Environment, perception, and relationship quality change which genes are active. Inherited patterns of stress and reactivity are modifiable — awareness begins to shift them.	Lipton, Biology of Belief, 2005 Meaney & Szyf, Nature Neuroscience
Peer Support Efficacy	Structured peer listening reduces cortisol, increases oxytocin, and improves immune function. Being accurately heard — without advice or rescue — is a measurable physiological intervention with decades of research support.	Co-Counselling International

Group Coherence Effects	January 2026 peer-reviewed study: during 15 coherence meditations (1,000–2,200 participants each), random number generators worldwide showed synchronized deviations only during those sessions. Mean correlation 0.27, $p < 0.01$. Newer science — peer-reviewed but actively debated.	Dispenza & HeartMath, EXPLORE (Elsevier), Jan 2026 Global Coherence Initiative

Balance note: HRV coherence and polyvagal regulation are well-established and widely replicated. Group consciousness research is peer-reviewed but actively debated. The protocol works regardless.

PART 1: FULL PREPARATION PROTOCOL

When: Before any negotiation, difficult conversation, AI interaction, or consequential decision.
5 minutes. No equipment.

#	Step	What to do	Why it works	Time
1	**Settle**	Sit. Close eyes. 3 slow breaths. Feel your body contact the chair and floor.	Activates the parasympathetic nervous system. Signals safety. Reduces cortisol.	1 min
2	**Notice**	Ask silently: "What am I carrying that may not be mine? A tension, a reactivity, a pattern from my history or my lineage?"	Inherited patterns shape current perception. Naming them begins to loosen their grip.	1 min
3	**Return**	"I bring my full attention back to this moment, this room, this task."	Attention is the raw material of decision. Scattered attention produces scattered outcomes.	1 min
4	**Heart Coherence**	Hand on heart. Breathe: in 5 counts · hold 5 · out 5. Repeat 3 times.	Measurably increases HRV within minutes. Creates physiological coherence.	2 min
5	**Intention**	"What quality do I want to bring? Clarity? Genuine curiosity? Precision? Composure?"	Intention shapes what you perceive. Pre-setting it narrows reactive noise.	30 sec

PART 2: FULL SESSION PROTOCOL

Role	Responsibilities	Key constraint
Person A — Speaker	Shares what is alive. Commits to honesty. Completes pre-session preparation.	Be honest. Trust the space.
Person B — Listener	Listens without fixing, advising, or diagnosing. Reflects accurately.	No advice. No rescue. No interpretation.
AI Tool — Optional	Guides timing. Generates neutral summaries. Monitors for crisis language.	Never counsels. Never acts alone. Human always in charge.

#	Phase	What happens	Facilitator note	Time
1	**Opening**	Both share intention in one sentence.	Brief. Intention, not agenda.	2 min
2	**First Sharing**	A speaks fully. B listens — no fixing, no advice, no reassurance, no interruptions.	B tracks what is said, not prepares a response.	10–15 min
3	**Reflection**	B: "What I heard you say is..." A confirms or corrects. No interpretation.	Mirror, don't amplify. Accuracy matters.	2 min
4	**Human Response**	B: "What resonated with me was..." Warmth, <u>not</u> analysis.	Presence, not expertise.	2 min
5	**Pattern ID**	Together name one recurring theme — without judgment.	One pattern only. Name it lightly.	3 min
6	**Switch Roles**	Repeat phases 2–5 with B as Speaker.	Full equal time. Resist rushing.	15–25 min
7	**Integration**	One insight + one concrete small action each.	Small. Doable. Before next session.	5 min
8	**Closing**	Shared silence. Gratitude — however expressed.	No debrief. Let it land.	1 min

SAFETY PROTOCOL — FULL DETAIL

This protocol is for peer support, not therapy.
Know your escalation path before the session begins.

Situation	Immediate response	Do not
Participant becomes distressed	Pause. "Take your time. I'm here." Stay present. Do not rush.	Advise, rescue, fix, or problem-solve.
Crisis or safety concern	Pause immediately. Connect to pre-identified professional resources.	Continue the session. Minimise or reason.
You feel out of your depth	"I want to make sure you get the right support." Refer. Follow up.	Pretend you can hold more than you can.
AI tool malfunctions	Continue without it. Protocol is fully functional without technology.	Wait for the AI. It is optional, not essential.

REFERENCES

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8.	HeartMath Global Coherence Initiative. [Link]
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10.	Arms Control Association — NPT RevCon 2026 coverage. [Link]

"The machine is the mirror. The humans are the healers. Love is the medicine."

The NPT was built on the belief that human beings could, together,
choose restraint over annihilation. That belief is still true.

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